

How does AI Actually use water?

Posted by u/Behindtheinkk • 0 points • 8 comments

I've heard so much recently about AI using water for this and that but how is the water actually used and lost?

Comments

u/RickyRacer2020 • 2 points • 2026-01-21 00:18 UTC

Water dissipates heat. Its why your car's engine is cooled wuth a mixture of it and antifreeze.

u/MODbanned • 5 points • 2026-01-21 00:06 UTC

Servers make alot of heat, the centres use evaporative cooling and chilled water loops, they also demand a lot of electricity, which also uses water.

u/Behindtheinkk • 1 points • 2026-01-21 00:10 UTC

Ohh,, that makes sense but when it evaporates wont it just become water eventually when it cools?

u/Moogatron88 • 1 points • 2026-01-21 00:49 UTC

That takes time and clouds move.

u/Fearlessleader85 • 1 points • 2026-01-21 00:48 UTC

It's a localized problem, not a worldwide one. That doesn't mean it doesn't matter.

u/Nuts4WrestlingButts • 3 points • 2026-01-21 00:24 UTC

Take a datacenter in California. They use thousands of gallons of water. It evaporates but the moisture is taken on the wind until it rains down into the ocean. We didn't "lose" the water, but we can't use it again.

u/Help_Me_Im_Diene • 4 points • 2026-01-21 00:17 UTC

Sure, but clouds move

So you end up relocating that water from the source to somewhere else on Earth, depending on when it eventually condenses and comes back down

And it takes time for this to happen, so for a while, you're just sequestering away water and leaving it inaccessible until it eventually comes back down

u/Patient-Dot-252 • 1 points • 2026-01-21 00:02 UTC

Cooling of the data centers. The GPUs use up so much energy they they heat up, but to maintain performance they need to remain cool. Water cooling is the most effective way of keeping the data centers cool